

Gothic Cathedrals

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Chartres Cathedral, completed in 1220, is renowned for its stained glass. The cathedral contains 152 original 13th-century windows, covering an area of 2,600 square meters. The distinctive blue of Chartres glass, now known as Chartres blue, has never been successfully replicated. The construction of Gothic cathedrals was an enormous undertaking, often spanning multiple generations. Entire towns participated in the building process. Master masons and architects developed sophisticated geometric and mathematical knowledge to achieve their soaring designs. Gothic architecture represented more than structural innovation; it embodied medieval theological concepts. The vertical emphasis symbolized humanity's aspiration toward heaven. Light, admitted through stained glass, represented divine presence. Every element of design carried symbolic meaning for medieval worshippers.